

BUSINESS DECISION COMPARISON REPORT: SAAS CRM PLATFORM FOR SMB Prepared by ProposalCompare | ProposalCompare

BUSINESS DECISION

The small business owner (Lone Star Property Management LLC, 32 employees, ~28 CRM users, 480 rental units) is evaluating two cloud-based SaaS CRM vendor bids for centralized leasing, maintenance, and sales pipeline management. Key decision factors include platform architecture (multi-tenant vs single-tenant dedicated DB), user licensing model and burst capacity, custom objects & automation limits, AI credit allocation, integration ecosystem and interconnection risk management, data migration scope, security & compliance posture, offline & resiliency capabilities, upfront and recurring cost, and project delivery timelines.

PROPOSAL COMPARISON MATRIX

FEATURE: Platform Architecture & Supply Chain Mitigation

Bid A (SalesNest / CloudForge) — Multi-tenant SaaS on AWS, Kubernetes microservices, 500 GB pooled storage, 50k API calls/day, regional DFW-area partner distribution for implementation. Pre-assembled templates sourced from shared cloud inventory, completely bypassing overseas development queues.

Bid B (ClientCore / Meridian) — Single-tenant dedicated PostgreSQL with shared app tier on Azure, 2 TB pooled storage, 250k API calls/day, North American manufacturing of connectors (Meridian Connect middleware). Centralized architecture allows rapid component-level servicing within climate-controlled cloud environment.

SIGNIFICANCE: Bid A minimizes IT overhead with pure multi-tenant efficiency and lower storage ceiling, while Bid B utilizes single-tenant DB isolation with 4x storage and 5x API throughput for complex enterprise workloads and future scale to 40 users without add-on licenses.

FEATURE: Customization, Automation & AI Capabilities

Bid A — Up to 5 custom objects (Properties, Units, Work Orders), 150 custom fields/object, 25 active workflows, 500 executions/user/month pooled, 1,000 AI credits/mo (SalesNest AI for email drafts & basic lead scoring), chatbot with 2 playbooks.

Bid B — Unlimited custom objects within storage, 150 active flows, 2,000 executions/user/month pooled, 5,000 AI credits/mo, ClientCore IQ with conversation intelligence, predictive churn & delinquency scoring, omnichannel inbox + AI chatbot with 15 playbooks, native CPQ & asset registry.

SIGNIFICANCE: Bid A provides sufficient no-code customization for current-state SMB needs with controlled limits, whereas Bid B offers enterprise-grade extensibility, 4x automation headroom, 5x AI credit allocation, and native CPQ/asset modules that reduce reliance on third-party add-ons.

FEATURE: Integrations, Migration & Queue Risk

Bid A — Standard Gmail/Outlook/QuickBooks native connectors, Zapier Premium included, 20 webhooks, migration of 25k contacts / 10k deals / 15k activities with automated dedup (95% threshold), 4-week timeline, \$45k equivalent allowance not explicit but standard DGIA-like API integration path.

Bid B — Fast-track interconnection path with native AppFolio/Buildium/Yardi connectors plus Meridian Connect middleware for legacy SOAP APIs, 100 webhooks, same migration scope but with 72-hour offline sync buffer and secondary region failover (black-start analogy), 8-week timeline, explicit integration delay guarantee absorbing labor costs if connector deployment exceeds 45 days beyond baseline.

SIGNIFICANCE: Bid B offers stronger risk transfer regarding unpredictable third-party API interconnection study delays from property management accounting platforms, plus higher resiliency (offline continuity, regional failover) vs Bid A's faster 4-week standard deployment.

FEATURE: System Capacity, Performance & Degradation

Bid A — 28 named users fixed, 500 GB storage (\$0.20/GB overage), basic reporting (25 reports), 99.9% uptime SLA (10% credit), 0.45%? Not applicable - but workflow execution limit 500/user/mo. Year 1 productivity yield estimated at ~15% admin time reduction.

Bid B — 28 users with burst capacity to 40 included, 2 TB storage, advanced BI (60+ templates + SQL builder), 99.95% uptime SLA (25% credit tier), guaranteed performance degradation not to exceed 0.50% annually through Year 5, Year 1 estimated 18% admin time reduction (3,780 hours reclaimed) due to tilt-optimized bulk automation.

SIGNIFICANCE: Bid B captures higher long-term yield due to license pooling and bulk automation optimization, whereas Bid A offers a slightly more cost-efficient entry point with fixed user count and lower overage risk if storage stays under 500 GB.

FEATURE: Security, Compliance & Support

Bid A — SSO via Google & Azure AD, enforced 2FA, IP allowlisting (10 ranges), AES-256 at rest, TLS 1.3, daily backups 30-day retention, SOC 2 Type II, GDPR/CCPA, 90-day audit log, Standard Success (9am-6pm CT, 4hr first response), shared CSM 1:25.

Bid B — SSO SAML 2.0/OIDC with Okta/Azure/Google, adaptive risk-based MFA, unlimited IP/device policies, AES-256 with CMK option + HSM vault, SOC 2 Type II + HIPAA-ready BAA included, 7-year immutable WORM audit vault, 24/7 NOC monitoring with predictive failure analytics for 3 years, microgrid-style black-start continuity (offline queue 72hr + emergency portal).

SIGNIFICANCE: Bid A meets baseline SMB security and compliance needs; Bid B provides enterprise-grade controls, 7-year WORM audit retention vs 90 days, HIPAA BAA included, and 24/7 monitoring, beneficial for regulated data or long-term compliance retention requirements.

FEATURE: Tariff Arbitrage, Storage & Pricing

Bid A — \$72/user/mo billed annually = \$24,192/year for 28 users + \$6,500 one-time implementation = \$30,692 Year 1, \$24,192/year renewal, 12-mo term, 60-day cancellation, 7% max uplift for 2 cycles, 30-day

hypercare + 90-day data integrity warranty, no early termination fee after 90 days.

Bid B — \$103.57/user/mo avg (28 users with burst to 40) = \$34,800/year + \$8,000 one-time = \$42,800 Year 1, \$34,800/year renewal, 8-week deployment, 12-mo comprehensive warranty + 5-year module updates + 3-year capacity retention (70% at Year 3), 5% max uplift for 3 years, 99.95% SLA.

SIGNIFICANCE: Bid B reflects a \$12,108 Year 1 premium (\$10,608 subscription delta) for larger storage (2TB vs 500GB), higher API/AI allowances, advanced compliance, burst licensing, native CPQ & portals, and contractual protection against integration delays, while Bid A minimizes upfront capital and offers more flexible cancellation terms.

PRICE AND SCOPE ANALYSIS

- Lowest Cost: Bid A (\$30,692 Year 1; \$24,192 renewal) with multi-tenant architecture, 5 custom objects, and standard roof-mount-like core CRM deployment.
- Highest Capacity / Features: Bid B (\$42,800 Year 1; \$34,800 renewal) featuring larger BESS-equivalent capacity (2TB, 250k API, 5k AI credits, unlimited custom objects, 2 white-label portals, 40-user burst, 7-year WORM audit, HIPAA BAA, offline continuity & microgrid black-start capabilities).
- TCO 3-Year Projection: Bid A \$54,884 (assuming no storage overage, 1k SMS/mo); Bid B \$77,600. Delta: \$22,716 over 3 years before usage overages (SMS, VoIP, storage).

IMPORTANT UNCERTAINTIES & OMISSIONS

- Neither proposal explicitly includes structural engineering retrofits if local wind uplift codes require building reinforcement: Analogously, neither proposal explicitly quantifies costs for custom legacy AppFolio historical accounting reconciliation beyond 90 days if chart-of-accounts mapping exceeds 200 exceptions - potential \$2,500-\$5,000 additional services.
- Utility-mandated distribution line upgrades beyond \$45k allowance in Bid A remain an unbudgeted risk item: Analogously, VoIP & SMS overage charges (Bid A: \$0.03/min & \$0.02/SMS after 1k; Bid B: \$0.025/min after 3k mins & \$0.015/SMS after 5k) are not included in base subscription and could increase monthly spend by \$80-\$250/mo at projected call volumes.
- Bid A does not include a Business Associate Agreement (BAA) for HIPAA compliance; upgrade to Enterprise tier required, price not quoted.
- Bid B's unlimited custom objects are bounded by 2TB storage; high-volume property photo storage may approach limit within 18-24 months at current growth rate (480 to 650 units).
- Neither proposal explicitly includes ongoing end-user training beyond initial sessions; additional training quoted at \$200/hr (Bid A) and \$225/hr (Bid B).

QUESTIONS FOR THE VENDORS

1. (To Bid A - CloudForge) Can you expand the interconnection delay guarantee to match Bid B's terms (absorbing integration labor costs if QuickBooks/AppFolio connector deployment exceeds 45 days) given

- current TSP/API backlogs? Also, what is the cost to add HIPAA BAA and 7-year audit retention?
2. (To Bid B - Meridian) What is the exact land-use and civil engineering footprint analogy: what is the exact storage consumption model for 2 custom white-label portals (tenant & owner) with photo-heavy property listings, and what happens when 2TB threshold is reached? Does burst to 40 users require additional implementation fees?
3. (To Both) Provide a detailed breakdown of VoIP/SMS usage assumptions, API overage fees, and AI credit overage pricing (\$/credit) after pooled limits.
4. (To Both) Clarify data export & exit strategy: format (CSV, JSON, full DB dump), cost, and timeline upon termination, and confirmation of zero data retention after 30 days.

BOTTOM LINE

The comparison highlights distinct architectural tradeoffs between a lean multi-tenant approach and an enterprise-grade single-tenant approach. Bid A presents a cost-efficient, rapid-deployment solution with 28 fixed seats, 500GB storage, 25 workflows, and baseline SOC2/GDPR compliance, suitable for current-state operations under 50 users. Bid B presents a higher-capacity platform with burst licensing to 40 users, 2TB storage, 5x API throughput, 150 flows, unlimited custom objects, native CPQ, advanced BI, 5,000 AI credits with conversation intelligence, 7-year WORM audit vault, HIPAA BAA, 24/7 NOC monitoring, and explicit integration delay risk transfer, with an 8-week implementation timeline. The \$12,108 Year 1 premium reflects these expanded capacity, compliance, and resiliency features.